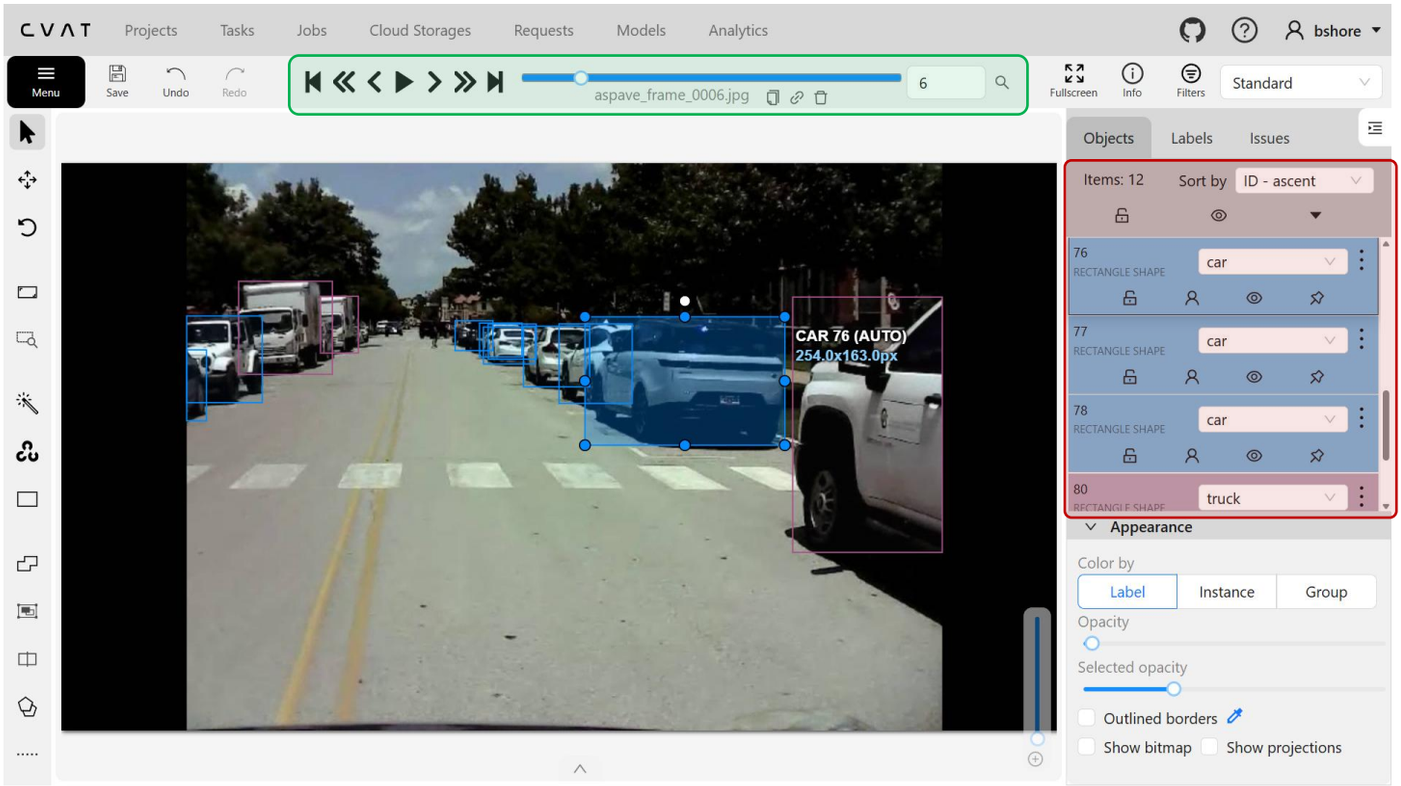
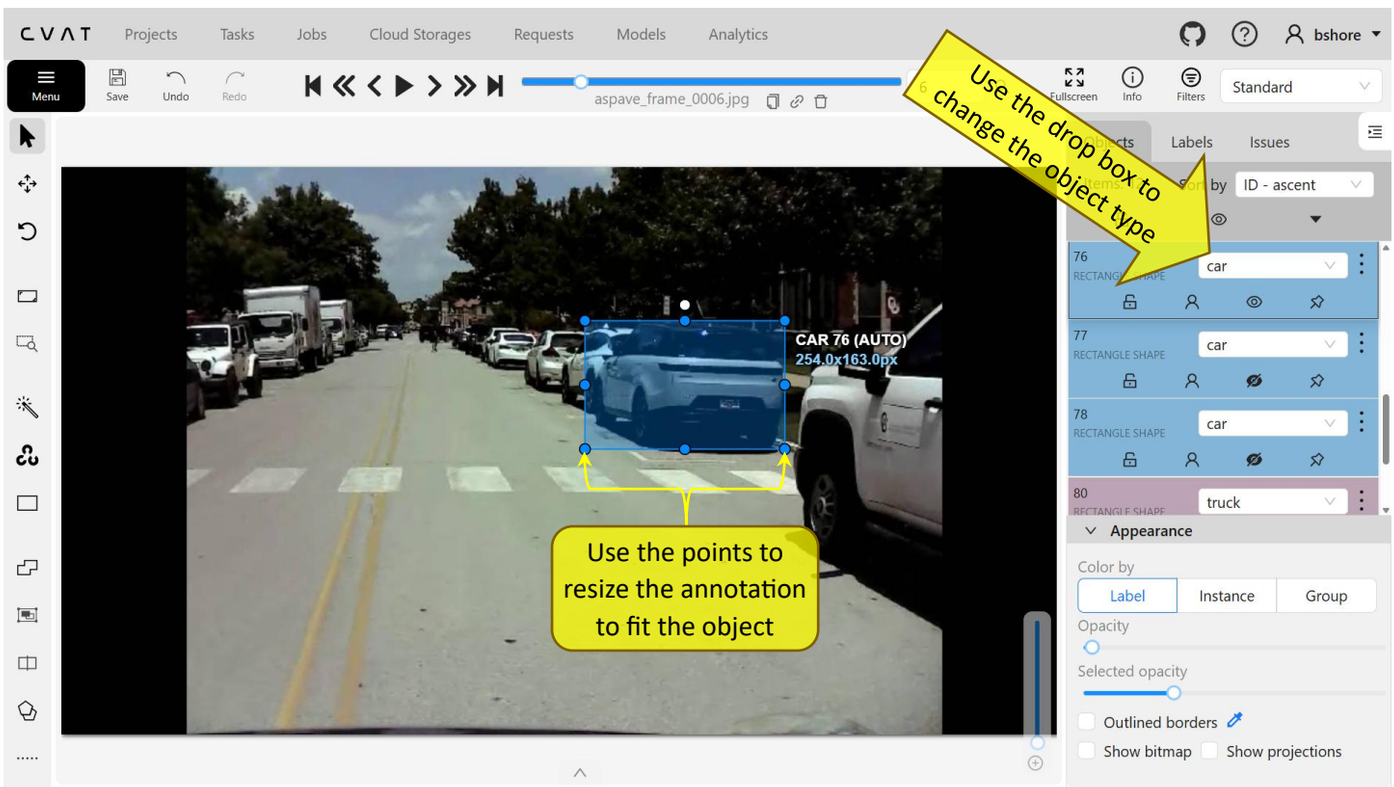
CVAT Manual Annotations Guide

This is a guide on how to complete step 3 of the pipeline. This can be done after completing step 2, meaning you have CVAT running on your computer and you have already ran automatic annotations.

Step 1: Click on the name of a job to be taken to the editing screen. Here you can use the controls at the top to move between frames of the video. On the right is where you can see all the existing annotations for the current frame shown. Each frame has its own set of autogenerated annotations that are independent from one another. Clicking on an annotation in the frame will outline it in the side menu, and clicking on an annotation in the side menu will select it in the frame. The annotation number can be used to match the on-screen annotations with the ones in the side menu.

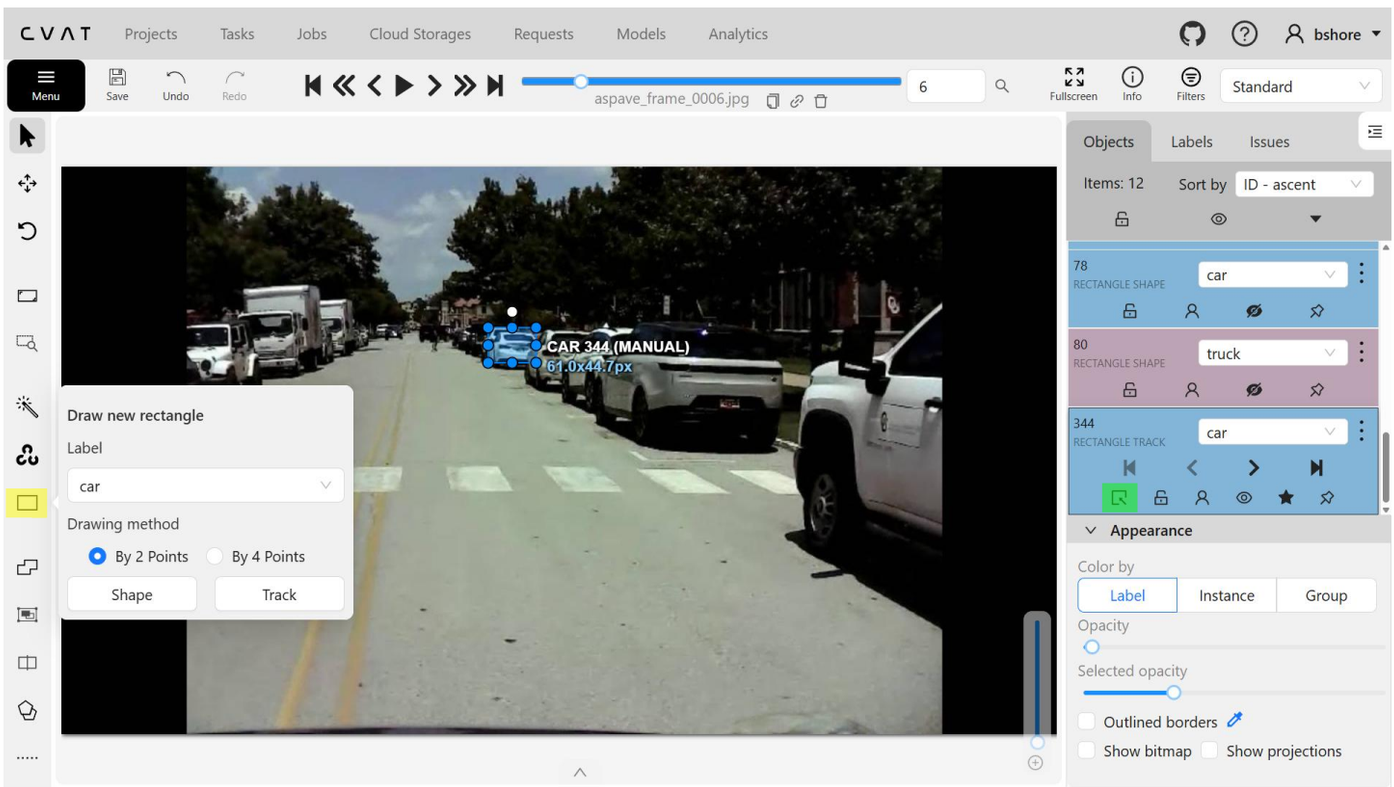
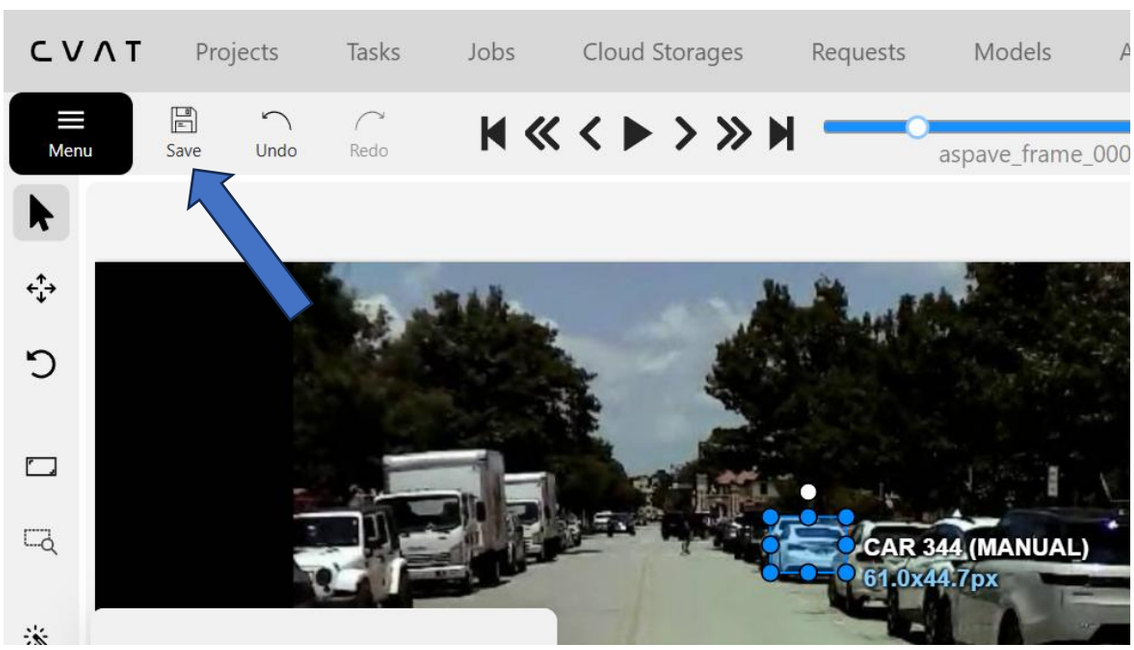


Step 2: To correct annotations made by the autogenerator, select a bad annotation to alter it. You can reposition, resize, and reclassify it. Note, the three dots menu has an option to delete it completely if it shouldn't exist.



Step 3: To add new annotations to objects that the autogenerator missed completely, press the highlighted rectangle button on the left side tool bar. Here you can set the object type of the new annotation and then select **shape** or **track** to draw the annotation.

- **Shape** places a new annotation for the current frame only. After being placed, it can be altered just like the autogenerated annotations.
- **Track** places an annotation that is present in the current frame and all later frames. This annotation can be edited to a different position and size per frame. Altering its size or position in a frame will set that frame as a *keyframe*, and the annotation in all later non-keyframes will update to match the keyframe most prior to it.
    - If the object is no longer on screen in a later frame, then the highlighted button in the side menu can be used to hide the annotation for that frame. This creates a keyframe, so the annotation will also be hidden in all remaining frames unless a later frame unhides it.



Step 4: Use Ctrl+S or press the save button to save your edits.